

Chapter 6

Cultural and Ethnic Considerations

Lesson 6.1: Cultural and Ethnic Considerations

1. Identify the importance of transcultural nursing.
2. Explain what health disparities are and what nurses can do to improve health care in these populations.
3. Explain how personal cultural beliefs and practices affect nurse-patient and nurse-nurse relationships.
4. Identify and discuss cultural variables that potentially influence health behaviors.
5. Explain how cultural data can be used to help develop therapeutic relationships with the patient.
6. Discuss cultural and religious influences as they relate to the older adult.
7. Discuss the use of the nursing process in the care of culturally diverse patients.

Transcultural Nursing

- United States described as “melting pot” from many different countries
- More people are identifying as biracial, Hispanic, and black (U.S. Census Bureau, 2012)
- Transcultural nursing
 - Understanding and integrating variables into all aspects of nursing care

Health Disparities

- Preventable, negative health outcomes that are disproportionately affect socially and economically disadvantaged populations

Culture Defined

- Set of learned values, beliefs, customs, and practices that are shared by a group and passed from one generation to another
- Subculture
 - Share characteristics with primary culture
 - Has characteristic patterns of behavior and ideals that distinguish it from the rest of cultural group

Cultural Competence

- Nurses need to deliver culturally competent care and avoid stereotyping
- Unconscious bias
 - Unintentional bias that occurs from one's cultural stereotype
- Cultural bias
 - Belief that the beliefs and practices of one's culture is best

Cultural Influences

● Race and ethnicity

➤ Race

- Group of people who share biologic physical characteristics and hereditary factors

➤ Ethnicity

- Group of people who share a common social and cultural heritage based on shared traditions, national origin, and physical and biological characteristics

● Important not to make assumptions about a patient's belief or practice based on name, skin color, or language

Cultural Assessment

- Communication
- Space
- Time
- Social organization

Cultural and Religious Influences

- Religious beliefs and health care
- Health practices
- Biological variations

Nursing Process and Cultural Factors

- Nurse develops a care plan based on cultural background after assessing patient
- North American Nursing Diagnosis Association-International (NANDA-I) nursing diagnoses may not apply to culturally diverse patients
- To provide care and lessen limitations of the NANDA nursing diagnoses, the nurse must evaluate behavior of the prospective patient's culture
- The nurse, health care system, or both may be required to change in order to accommodate, maintain, or reinforce patients' health beliefs and

Cultural Practices of Specific Groups

- Mexican Americans
- African Americans
- Chinese Americans
- Muslim Americans
- American Indians